



FLAT CHAT NEWSLETTER
AUSTIN-HEALEY OWNERS CLUB (NSW) INC
ABN: 87 630 303 136

Workshops – Working Again

We are pleased that this coming Saturday 6th November starting at 9am will see members coming together again for the first post-lockdown workshop at the Central Coast home of Kerrie and Colin Rule – 109 Humphreys Road, South Kincumber.

This month will be a demonstration on fitting BJ8 windscreens, so all are welcome and yes NSW Health Covid guidelines will be followed.

Don't forget to bring your library books for exchange, and please bring a plate with biscuits or cake to share. Coffee and tea will be supplied.

Kerri and Colin are really looking forward to seeing all the gang again.

So Happy Healeying and stay safe.



VOL. 8 ISSUE #11
November 2021

COMING EVENTS

November

4th Annual General Meeting
at Strathfield Golf Club
10th Committee Meeting

December

2nd Christmas Party at
Strathfield Golf Club

Watch this Space!

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Our monthly meetings are held at Strathfield Golf Club, 52 Weeroona Rd, Strathfield NSW 2135 on the 1st Thursday of each month commencing at 7.30pm.

Members and guests are welcome to join us for dinner in the bistro from 5.30pm.

PRESIDENT'S MESSAGE

A little over a month ago various state premiers and health officials were pessimistic about the chances of eradicating the Delta strain of Coronavirus. Our Premier was saying that vaccination was the only real solution as the number of new cases per day remained stubbornly high. Since then, vaccinations have been going apace to the point where the NSW government has removed almost all travel restrictions and significantly reduced social restrictions. Within a week we went from despairing of being able to leave our Local Government Area, to allowing people a close facsimile of normal life and almost unrestricted travel.

Capitalising on this optimism, November will see us meet in person once more. Government allowing, we shall be holding the November General Meeting and AGM at Strathfield Golf Club. The room is booked, and the bistro has been forewarned to expect 36 to 40 of

us for dinner between 5:30 and 6:30.

November 4th is also our Annual General Meeting where we elect the Club's management committee for the coming year. Committee members are always happy to welcome club members to join them in keeping the club going and events happening. If you can do so, please think about taking up a role to keep our great club functioning. If you are not sure about what roles there are, just have a look at the minutes of any general meeting as published in Flat Chat each month.

Sadly, not all States are faring so well as NSW. Whether we would be allowed to travel to Mildura for the Mini-Rally had been a question on my mind for quite some time. Well, now we know. With just five weeks to go, Mildura became a hot spot and the Victorian AHOC once again had to cancel



Gordon Lynas – 0403 198 343 – gordonl@aussiebb.com.au

their rally. I'm sure that like me you feel every sympathy for our Victorian friends. To have to cancel a Rally once is bad enough, but three times! One can only admire their fortitude in having another try next May. I hope many NSW members will repay that effort by booking to attend when details are published.

Cont' Page 6

COMMITTEE LIST - 2021

Club Patron—Ross Bond

President - Gordon Lynas
4 Wanari Road
Terrey Hills NSW 2084
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gordonl@aussiebb.com.au

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joea6@bigpond.com

Membership Secretary - Christine Lyttle
0410 201 373
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Regalia - Colin Rule
0467 563 523
coolibahconvertible@bigpond.com

Technical Officer - Neville Stirton
0414 472 877
stirton@bigpond.net.au

Club Registrar - Patrick Quinn
(Inc Conditional Registration)
Please send all Conditional Registration documents to Patrick's postal address at left

Public Relations - Ross Penman
0408 465 547
penmans@bigpond.com

Webmaster - Jim Phillips
0413 589 306
jpjimbeau@gmail.com

Public Officer - Alan Mitchell
PO Box 123
Marulan 2579
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mitchellaj@ozemail.com.au

Non-Committee Positions
CSCA Delegate - Colin Goldsmith

Librarian - Ron Strange

CMC Delegates - Ray Roberts
Ian Clayton

Welfare Officer - Pamela Ross 0408 201 226

Display Day Coordinators - Ross & Jenny Penman

Conditional Registration Inspectors - Neville Stirton
0414 472 877
Geoff Smith
0458 777 339

Assn of British Car Clubs Reps - Christine Lyttle

National Assn Delegates - Gordon Lynas & Jim Phillips

AHOC Life Members - Don Read, Warwick Sell, Joe Armour, Christine Lyttle, Patrick Quinn, Terry Bancroft, Ray Roberts and David Mould.

If you want to send something by post, the Club's address is:-

AHOC (NSW) Inc
PO Box 6494
North Ryde NSW 2113

It would be appreciated if there were no phone calls to committee members after 9:00 PM.

EXHAUST LEAKS



By Patrick Quinn
(02) 4567 7380
0417 673 065
p_quinn@tpg.com.au

Greetings and welcome to the November 2021 issue of the *Flat Chat Newsletter*.

Well lockdown has finished and most are coming out of hibernation to see if their world has changed at all. Thankfully with the pandemic morphing into an endemic, the changes are somewhat more bearable.

All this means that while those changes are in the air, we haven't been in a situation of enjoying any events of late to include in this issue of Flat Chat. However having said that I trust there a few words and photos that may be of interest to one and all.

Thank you to Neil Janes for his update of the engine rebuild of his BN7 Mk1 and also to Alan Mitchell

for his flashback article on the Brass Monkey runs of a decade or so ago. Thank you too Will Sherman for buying his Austin-Healey as it provided an interesting subject to write about.

Other things to read include a long forgotten article on the club's involvement in the 1973 Calder Six-Hour Relay Races. I found another Austin-Healey in deplorable condition in the US and thought we should see how lucky we are with our climate in this country. I also found a Healey 707 for sale in the UK that I thought everyone should know about. You will have to turn to the article on page 27 to find out what a Healey 707 is. A special thanks to David Stimson for his memories of his 100.

All the normal stuff is there for your contemplation including a new Q&A on technical questions concerning our Austin-Healeys. There is a first time for everything and I hope that other members will feel inclined to send in a question or two to include in future issues.

It's been an interesting month with the Quinn Austin-Healey with bits and pieces being refitted. Of significance have been the door check straps, which were not

fitted when the car was previously restored during the 1980s. Back then things just happened and the front guards were fitted and then I remembered the check straps. With the 100 bodies it is somewhat simpler to have the front guards removed to fit the straps. With the guards removed it was simple to fit the straps while making sure that both were fixed in such a way that they wouldn't fall through to the inside of the guards.

Now the next part is the most useless piece of trivia you could imagine. The check straps in all big Healeys attach to the forward facing edge of the door through a chrome plated shoe. In roadster bodied cars (100 to Mk2 Roadster) the shoe attaches to the door by two screws, spring washers and 3/16 UNF nuts. With the convertibles the shoe attaches to a triangular bracket with the screws fastening to captive nuts. However nowhere in any of the parts suppliers information do the nuts and washers get a mention. Confusion reigned supreme until I worked all that out. See it's all useless trivia.

Trust you enjoy this issue of the *Flat Chat Newsletter* and I look forward to receiving your photos and words.



Quinn Austin-Healey



Mark Donaldson's BN2



Jim Phillips' BN4



BJ8 Check Strap with triangular bracket



Minutes of the General Meeting

Thursday, 7 October 2021.

Commenced: 7:40pm.

Venue - Zoom Video Conference

ATTENDEES

Refer attendance list.

VISITORS & NEW MEMBERS

There were no visitors or new members.

APOLOGIES

Patricia Bancroft, Glenn Barnes, Mal French, Garry Lee, Christine Lyttle, Patrick & Caroline Quinn, Doug & Pamela Ross, Judy Sherman and Geoff Smith.

APPROVAL OF MINUTES

Resolved that the minutes of the General Meeting held 2 September 2021, as published in the October 2021 issue of *Flat Chat*, be verified as a correct record of that meeting.

PRESIDENT'S REPORT

Gordon was very pleased to announce that if there was no further lockdown, the next general meeting would be held at the Strathfield Golf Club! He was also excited at the prospect that his Mildura Meander would be able to go ahead, even if only to Swan Hill. However if Victorian vaccination numbers kept up, he hoped that the run would be able to cross the border into Victoria to attend the Victorian Mini-Rally. And on the topic of the MM, he'd had a cancellation that day, so if anyone was keen to join in, he asked that they get in touch with him.

Gordon advised that Christine Lyttle was in the process of organising the Club's Christmas party. There'd been a change of caterers at the Golf Club, but it was unclear at this stage what impact that might have.

VICE-PRESIDENT'S REPORT

No report.

SECRETARY'S REPORT

Julie advised of snail mail received:

- *The Australian Jaguar Driver* – September

Electronic magazines and newsletters received:

- *Healeys West* (WA) – September & October
- *Speed Read* (MSA) – September
- *National Motor Museum Newsletter* – September

- *Rally Directions* (CRC) – September
- *The Preserve* (CMC) – October
- *Healey Torque* (Qld) – October
- *Motorlife News* – October

Other emails received:

- A potential membership enquiry which had been passed onto Christine Lyttle and Patrick Quinn.

TREASURER'S REPORT

John advised of the Club's funds as at 30 September 2021:

Debit card	\$301.93
Main Account	\$23,125.08
Cash Reserve	\$12,500.38
Charlie's Run	\$2,944.09
Term Deposit	\$78,945.63
Interest Earned	\$0.12

The only payment for the month had been to reimburse Patrick for the Adobe software used for *Flat Chat*.

SOCIAL SECRETARY'S REPORT

Bruce was excited to report that Sydney was on track to start exiting lockdown on 11 October, and by 25 October, with expectations of 80% vaccination, restrictions would ease even further, potentially to 2sqm per person indoors, rather than 4sqm. This was important for the Christmas party, as the higher requirement would restrict numbers.

Bruce advised he was going to be away the first few weeks in November, but he would plan a social gathering for the last weekend in November. Jim suggested the Goulburn Car & Motorcycle Show as a possible event.

Other good news was that the workshops could start up again, so Colin would be holding one at his Central Coast property on 6 November. Bruce was keen for a Sydney-based workshop the weekend following, but with being away, someone else would have to organise it.

WELFARE OFFICER'S REPORT

No report

WEBMASTER'S REPORT

Jim didn't have much to report other than the format of emails from the website had changed, so they



might look a bit different. He also advised that Bruce had been discussing with Andrew from MYCCO about having an RSVP for events on the website. Gordon added that the Club would need to keep the old manual method available for those members who didn't have internet or email.

A question for the Committee to consider was how the Club would deal with requesting a member's vaccination status for events.

MEMBERSHIP

No report

EDITOR'S REPORT

On behalf of Patrick, Julie advised that *Flat Chat* had been issued the previous evening, with only one bounce back. Patrick had also passed on his thanks to those members who'd provided contributions for the magazine.

REGISTRAR

Again, on behalf of Patrick, Julie advised that quite a few renewals had been received. Patrick had also requested that members read the HVS information which had been included in the October *Flat Chat*.

Despite difficulties other members had reported in previous months, Julie and several other members advised that they'd had no problems more recently with renewing their HVS registrations at Service NSW branches.

HISTORIAN

No report

LIBRARIAN

No report

TECHNICAL OFFICER/CLUB EQUIPMENT/ SPARE PARTS

No report.

PUBLIC RELATIONS REPORT

Ross advised that unfortunately, the Show & Shine wasn't going to go ahead for 2021. The Committee would discuss potential timing for 2022.

CMC REPORT

No report

ASSOCIATION OF BRITISH CAR CLUBS

No report

CSCA REPORT

Colin advised that the Jaguar Club Supersprint, which was the last Supersprint for the year, was going ahead, albeit with lots of COVID restrictions. Also, the HSRCA would be running a race meeting at Wakefield Park on 5 November.

He didn't have much else to report on CSCA matters, as the CSCA hadn't had a meeting since April or May.

He'd also heard that the Sprite Club had had a Supersprint lined up at Eastern Creek in 2022, but the date was cancelled on them because apparently the Supercars wanted it.

REGALIA

With no meetings or events, Colin had been very quiet on the regalia front, but he still had a few wind-screens to distribute, so was going to speak to John Sherman after the meeting to sort out who had bought what.

FOR SALE/WANTED

Nothing. Nada. Zilch.

GENERAL BUSINESS

Jeff Burton advised that he did a radio show from 10-11am every Saturday morning (89.3FM Liverpool), so if the Club wanted anything publicised, to let him know.

Back on the topic of vaccinations at Club events, it was agreed to take it on trust at the moment, but the Committee would need to develop a more formal policy.

John Wakeling advised that a Cars & Coffee event was scheduled for 7 November at St Ives Show-ground – entrants could just turn up on the day.

In response to a question from John about whether the Golf Club would also be able to provide facilities to still have a Zoom meeting, Gordon advised he needed to look into the logistics.

Julie advised that timing for the AGM was on track and it would be discussed at the next Committee meeting.

Meeting concluded at 8:40pm

It's time we got out again, won't it be great to meet face to face!

How about a Christmas Party to celebrate!

Make your booking today, don't delay and miss out.



A two course menu will be served with drinks.

If you have any food intolerances or allergies, please advise in your reply email when advising your booking.

To secure your seat, please reply by return email christinelyttle@hotmail.com and deposit \$40 for each ticket into the club's bank account with the description "YOUR NAME Xmas".

Account details

BSB: 032 669

Account: 252564

We look forward to seeing you at the Party!

President's Message Cont'

With our new 'freedoms', our first social event other than a general meeting will be the 'Mildura Meander' beginning the day after the AGM. I had already revised the route to stay in NSW until the very last moment, so that we could go whatever the border crossing situation might be. Even so, until a couple of weeks ago I was doubtful whether we would be allowed to travel anywhere, let alone cross the state and venture into Victoria. How times change! When I heard that the Mini-Rally was postponed I contacted each of those who had booked to travel on the 'Meander'. The response was unequivocal. To quote one reply, "Desperate to go on a run ... please, please, I beg you not to cancel." The others were all affirmative if not quite so dramatic. So how could I do other than accede to their demands? We won't get

to Mildura, but we will have fun visiting a number of country towns before returning home. Although there are only eight cars they are coming from far and wide across the state. All we need now is for the weather to be kind to us. (Fingers crossed.)

After many postponements, our social programme is also re-starting, so get your Austin-Healeys ready for socialising with the club and watch *Flat Chat* for details. It's going to be great to see a line of Austin-Healeys parading through the state once more.

See you at Strathfield soon

Happy Healeying
Gordon

We have one new member this month. James Moffatt with a 3000 MKI BT7 from Bondi Junction in the Eastern Suburbs. We welcome you to the Club James.

The Annual General Meeting will be held at the Strathfield Golf Club this month. The meeting is on Thursday 4 November commencing at 7.30pm. If you would like to join us for dinner, meet in the Bistro from 5.30pm – 6.00pm. Reminder you will be required to be double vaccinated to attend the premises.

Remember, we can only have details correct about you, if you advise us and update them, so please let me know of your changes of phone numbers, email and home addresses to the email on the right. Also, you can change your address, email or any other detail online through the AHOC website at <https://www.austinhealeynsw.com.au/>

Social Report

Bruce Ewan 0432 096 493
bruce.ewan1@gmail.com

Final 2021 social gatherings

It is time to lift the dust cover, roll up the garage door and fire up the Austin-Healey. Let's hit the highway, get together and celebrate.

As the first Austin-Healey meeting is way too long away, I wanted this gathering to have the feel of a festival and celebration, now that we can get out and meet friends. Therefore, let's celebrate our common passion with other car aficionados. In 2019, this event had over 2,000 visitors, and is one of the larger regional car shows.

Goulburn Car and Motorcycle Show 2021

On the 27th of November 2021 the Goulburn Car and Motorcycle Show is on again! The show will be held at the Goulburn Showgrounds, Braidwood Road, Goulburn NSW. All proceeds of the day go to the Goulburn PCYC 'Rise Up' programs for youth.

All cars and motorcycles are welcome to show and enjoy the day. Entries are \$20 and each category will be judged by a People's Choice vote. Show entries are between 8am and 10am and general admission is between 8.30 and 2pm. There are 33 trophies on

Membership Report Christine Lyttle

0410 201 373

membership@austinhealeynsw.com.au



If you haven't looked at the website for a time, you will notice that there are a lot of photographs added for us to enjoy.

Keep safe and well!
Happy Healeying
Christine Lyttle

offer for cars and bikes and all entrants have the chance to win one of three \$500 prizes.

A new addition for this year's show is a street parade from 5pm in Auburn Street.

Please register to attend through the events page of our website: <https://www.austinhealeynsw.com.au/events/>

Please include contact details, so that I can keep each who are attending updated with details on meeting points and times.

Looking forward to seeing everyone in Goulburn.

Additionally if you have not booked for the Christmas Party please do so ASAP. It's scheduled for Thursday 2nd December 2021 from 6:30pm at Strathfield Golf Club. For further detail please see the previous page.

Till then, keep safe and be well.



Works Rally 3000 77 ARX in action



Historic Vehicle Registration News

If you have a car on Historic Vehicle Registration you should read this.

It's been a busy month with the total of vehicles historically registered through the AHOC climbing to 209 including one new marque vehicle, a BJ8.

The month also included a renewal by one member that ended up with him starting all over again. In case you didn't know, and this applies to all vehicles registered in NSW and not just those historically registered, we have three calendar months from the renewal date to re-register a vehicle. We all know that we receive the paperwork from Transport for NSW around four weeks prior to the due date. The due date marks the start of the three months and if you don't finalise the transaction within that time

you lose the registration and cannot renew it. You will have to start again.

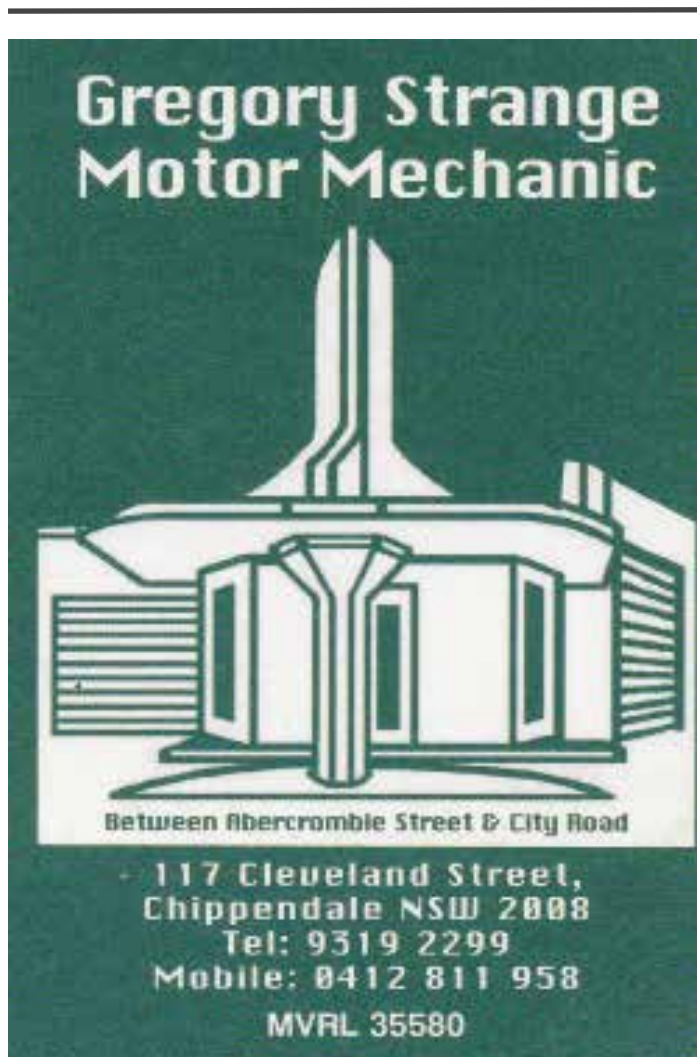
Starting again with Historic Vehicle Registration means that you hand in the old plates and apply for new registration and new plates. That's exactly what happened to our club member who was just four days past the three months.

So we have close to four months to finalise the registration which appears to be simple enough, but it does surprise me that a number of renewals do seem to happen quite close to the end of the period. I can accept however that during lockdown and everything that flows from it, using their historically registered car is probably the last thing on people's minds.

Talking about renewals, I do wonder how many members read these words as over the last month I have received four enquiries as to how to reregister their vehicle.

Once again here are the steps when renewing your Historic Vehicle Registration:-

- Once you have received the renewal, arrange for your vehicle to be inspected for roadworthiness by either an Authorised Inspection Station or one of the volunteer AHOC inspection officers. See page 2 of *Flat Chat* for their contact details. All vehicles including Historic vehicles need to be inspected and passed as roadworthy.
- Complete the left hand side of the "Historic Vehicle Declaration" and post it to me at my home address (See page 2 of *Flat Chat* for my address) along with an indication that your car is roadworthy or a copy of the pink slip. Include a stamped self-addressed envelope. There is no need to send me the registration certificate. Please do not post me the documents by Registered Post as that just slows down the process.
- Once returned, either go to your local Services NSW office to do the renewal or post to Transport for NSW in Parkes. That address can be found on the registration papers.



**Gregory Strange
Motor Mechanic**

Between Abercrombie Street & City Road

117 Cleveland Street,
Chippendale NSW 2008
Tel: 9319 2299
Mobile: 0412 811 958
MVRL 35580

Technical - Q & A

Let's see how far we go with a series of technical questions about Austin-Healeys, as after all the club has a resident Technical Officer in the form of Neville Stirton who would love to assist his fellow Austin-Healey owners.

If you have any questions about why your Austin-Healey behaves in a certain way, just send them in my direction and they will be published in the following *Flat Chat Newsletter* along with some observations that you can think about.

The first couple of questions come from John Oppenheim concerning his BJ8.

Q.

My BJ8 is starting slowly. It's the starter motor I think, as I have the battery in peak condition. It's a slow grind. Engine when it does fire is fine.

A.

Usually it's the starter motor as the bushes become worn to a U shape instead of a circle. However there are other things that's causing it like a bad earth, the isolator switch can be faulty, the battery too as while it might test okay, but under load it might fail. It's a matter of eliminating each thing until you find the problem.

Thanks Neville. Removing the starter is quite straightforward with just two nuts and bolts plus the electrical cable. Then you will need to find an auto electrician who knows Lucas. I have found that auto electricians are becoming few and far between. Recently I had the Lucas starter in the Quinn Healey

rebuilt by a mobile auto electrician. Apart from being connected by three bolts it's no different to that fitted to an Austin-Healey.

An alternative is to fit a high-torque starter in place of the original Lucas unit, but of course there is the originality question to consider.

Q.

I've noticed the car idles beautifully and then when it's really warm after an hour or so the revs rise....So idles about 800RPM and is 1100RPM after a while. Engine performs fine....Some sort of carby wear? No idea if it's a big issue or not.

Other than those issues, it's as fine an Austin-Healey as ever was built!

A.

Quite often this is caused by an air leak through the butterfly shaft. To test this is by using a bit of soapy water in a spray bottle. Spray it around the carburetors and inlet manifolds to see it makes any difference. If there is a leak it will alter the idle marginally for a second or two.

It's not always caused by a worn shaft, but it is pretty common as it's brass on aluminium that wears reasonably quickly.

The advice provided above is not necessarily that of the editor or the Austin-Healey Owners Club (NSW) Inc. If you have any doubts as to your ability to safely follow the advice it is recommend that you seek assistance from an appropriate professional.



John Oppenheim's BJ8



Will's new Austin-Healey

by Patrick Quinn

I was so pleased to hear the news that Will Sherman has bought himself an Austin-Healey.

Will is the son of past members Geoff and Mia Sherman and the nephew of our current treasurer John Sherman. Geoff and Mia originally owned a BN2 followed by a BJ7, and like so many children of members Will was brought up with Austin-Healeys being part of the family.

Will initially joined the club a few years back with an Austin-Healey Sprite which was later replaced by a MG Midget; however he had heart set on a Big Healey. So keen was Will in being involved, that he considered buying a C-series six-cylinder engine and restoring it.

At 31, Will is probably the youngest individual member of our club and is a Diesel Technician in the Royal Australian Navy. During the latest Covid lockdown he found what was advertised as a 3000 engine on Facebook Marketplace. It had been fitted to a boat, but on a close look, while it was a C-series

engine it originated from a BMC sedan and not an Austin-Healey.

Before making the decision about the engine he asked John whether there was any room in the Sherman garage for an engine rebuild. After that it all moved rather quickly as John had a chat to Robbie Rowland about his nephew's need for an Austin-Healey.

A deal was done and Will soon found himself with the prospect of restoring a 1961 MK2 BT7 (BT7L/14902), however he is quick to say that it's a Sherman family project. The car was originally Colorado Red with grey trim and delivered new to Philadelphia. It was imported into Australia at an unknown date and was advertised in carsales.com.au as a project back in 2013.

Will was convinced into the Mk2 as he didn't want a BJ8 as he prefers the original Austin-Healey shaped dash.

cont' next page



Will's car cont'

While John arranged for the engine to come to his place, the rest of the car remained at The Healey Factory. The engine has since been dismantled and frankly it's seen better days and in need of a complete rebuild. Interestingly a past owner had a large steel bracket welded around the sump, which Will says was done poorly as there is welding slag inside the sump. Apart from what's on the Heritage Certificate, its earlier US history is not known.

Will understands that The Healey Factory is doing what's necessary to the chassis and body, because

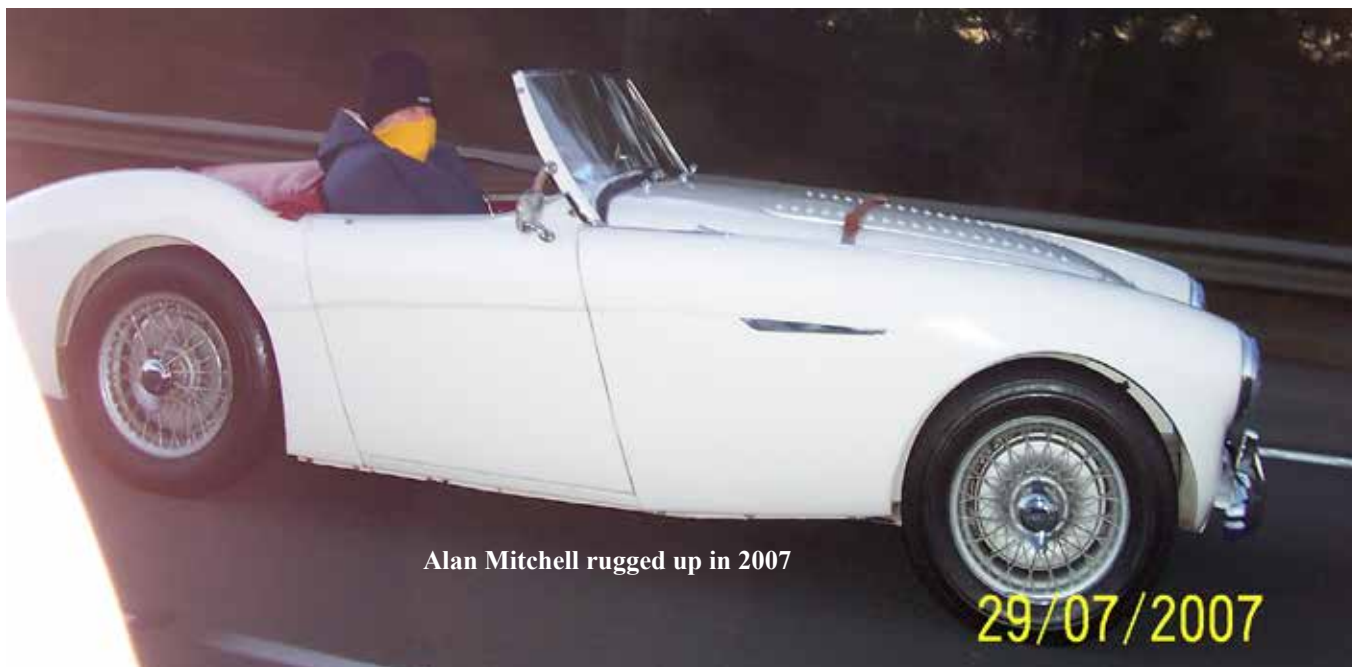
while he can undertake the mechanical work, not so the chassis and body work. He plans to undertake as much of the remaining work himself, but has asked Robbie Rowland to fit air conditioning at the appropriate time as requested by his fiancé. No doubt she was spoilt by being in John and Judy Sherman's BJ8.

It's wonderful to see the affection for Austin-Healeys being passed down generations and we all look forward to seeing Will Sherman's 3000 being put back on the road.



Flashback - The Brass Monkey Runs

By Alan Mitchell



Alan Mitchell rugged up in 2007

29/07/2007

Terry Bancroft had an idea of a winter breakfast “club” run that required that ALL soft tops be down and (if you were going to participate in a “tin top” with a sun roof) the sun roof had to be open only for the real bravehearts. The run also did raise some funds for our club.

In July we would meet between 5:30 am and 6:00am at a set location and then depart as soon as possible for a two hour drive in the cold winter’s morn to our breakfast location - be it Bathurst, Goulburn, Mudgee etc. or somewhere else within the two hours’ drive of our starting point. This invitation was available to other interested car clubs and the response was in-

credible: Rolls-Royce, Mazda, Sprite, Triumph, MG, Minis, Nissan, Lotus Sevens (inc replicas), Vauxhall etc. just to mention a few. BUT the requirement was for ALL soft tops to be down for the run to the breakfast location.

Over the years the attendees ranged in number sometimes 20-30 plus vehicles. For the brave attendees



the thought of a heart-warming breakfast at the end of a wintery top town run was too much to resist, but with all the heavy coats rugs and blankets to soften the cold as support. Those who attended were rewarded with a small oval badge to “commemorate” such an event. (In one run to Bathurst I was accompanied by daughter Sarah, who was very hesitant, but “enjoyed” the complete run wrapped in a blanket under the tonneau cover). I believe we did have one



Terry Bancroft probably had his heater on

29/07/2007

cont' next page

Brass Monkey cont'

accident with some "black ice" at Hartley.

Above is a photo of my old Austin-Healey's number plate with some of those commemorative badges for the runs: 2007 to Goulburn, 2009 to Bathurst, 2011 to Mudgee, 2012 to Bathurst, 2013 to Goulburn and 2014 to Mudgee. In addition there are some photos



Greg Strange looking stoic in his 100

29/07/2007



Now that does look cold

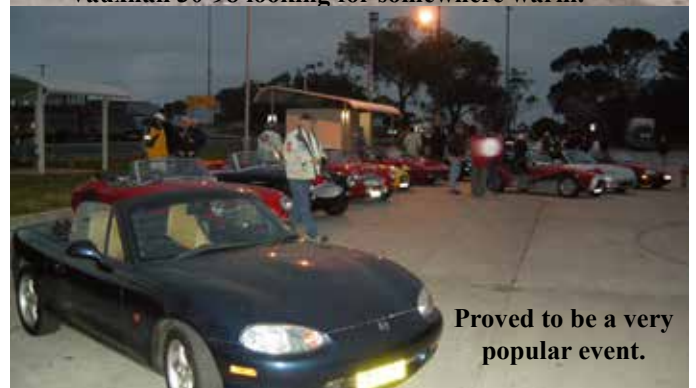
29/07/2007

of the brave souls who tackled such a "run" with the knowledge that there will be a hearty hot meal and tea/coffee awaiting them and time to share their experiences with the other "mad souls".

The things we did in our Austin-Healeys for fun, enjoyment and with good company.



Vauxhall 30-98 looking for somewhere warm.



Proved to be a very popular event.



PENINSULA SPORTS CAR SERVICES

BRITISH & CLASSIC CAR SPECIALISTS

- Engine, gearbox, suspension & brake rebuilds & upgrades
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Memories of my first Austin-Healey 100

By David Stimson

Now if you are wondering who David Stimson is, he is a patient of club member Bryan Levy. It intrigues me how when you're sitting in a dental chair the conversation can easily swing to the more enjoyable subject of Austin-Healeys.

Thank you to David for penning the below words for us to enjoy and to Bryan for steering David in the right direction.



Here is a photo taken around 1964 of my Austin-Healey parked near the Department of Civil Aviation's Technical Training School Carrington Road, Marrickville. I had been employed by the then Overseas Telecommunications Commission to be trained as a radio technician. A three year full time class room course. OTC and DCA turned out over a hundred trade graduates every year. What employer does this now? Sorry, I digressed.

The other photo is of myself and three of my fellow class mates. A Triumph TR2, my BN1, a MG TD and a Wolseley Hornet on the right.

My Austin-Healey went on to be my principal mode of transport for a number of years, shared later with my wife until family arrived, then we purchased a Jaguar Mk1

A number of mechanical events arose from time to time, some continuously. The engine was always inclined to suffer from pre-ignition. The cylinder head design didn't help, with a raised casting between the valve seats that got hot. The problem persisted until I made my own water injector that fixed it. Why weren't water injectors not more widely used? Some aircraft engines are so fitted, and I understand a lot of jet engines use water injection for take-off power. Water vapour dampens slows the rate of combustion, as does high octane fuel.

Another problem occurred with the overdrive unit as the actuating solenoid used to bind which required an internal fix. What a pain with all those springs and independent splines. Here is a photo of me trying to work out where the gear lever should go.

Another problem that thankfully didn't occur too often was a broken crankshaft. I remember when it happened as the engine had a bit of a knock. Upon



cont' next page

cont' from P14

inspection, as I removed big end caps, it was not until I got to the last main bearing near the flywheel that the problem was confirmed. I should add that this broken crank occurred before I fitted the water injector as I don't think the engine liked the pre-ignition.

I then went on a hunt for a second hand A90 or A70 crank around the numerous wrecking yards of Mar-rickville. Even though they were the same, an Aus-tin-Healey crank was too dear for me as a lowly paid apprentice. So, armed with a three inch micrometer,

I eventually found an A70 crankshaft which was not too out of round.

That's all that comes to mind at short notice although I've just had a memory jolt, some of your members would remember Frank Kleinig Motors on Parramat-ta Rd, where he used to sell water injectors.

I sold my 100 for \$800. Maybe I should have kept it.

All the best – Dave Stimson (Secretary Macquarie Towns MCC)



Tasmania Tour - 2022

At the request of the AHOC I have organised another Tasmania Tour in 2022.

If you wish to express your interest, please contact Terry Bancroft on 0409 323 133, or (02) 4777 4883 or bangers@bancroft.id.au

You may pull out up to around December 2021 with nil loss.

This will definitely be the last Tasmania Tour that Pat and I will be organising.

Itinerary

February 6th -	Departing Melbourne on the Spirit of Tasmania
February 7th -	Breakfast at the Edgewater Hotel Devonport
February 7th & 8th -	Overnight stay in Burnie
February 9th & 10th -	Overnight at the West Coaster Motel Queenstown
February 11th-14th -	Overnight at the Old Wool Store, Hobart
February 15th & 16th -	Overnight Bicheno
February 17th & 18th -	Overnight Casino Launceston
February 19th -	Depart Devonport for Melbourne on the Spirit of Tasmania

All mornings will include either a continental or a full breakfast depending on where we are.

Engine Rebuild Progress - Part 3

by Neil Janes



I have more progress to report, but as usual it seems to be two steps forward and one step back. Those who read my last update will remember that I needed to have the capillary tube on the water temperature gauge repaired. This appears to be successfully repaired by Humphrey Instruments at Unanderra in a very timely manner (Yay!). Hopefully it works when the car is running.

The engine is rebuilt, painted, has been returned to the car and is looking beautiful. I had noticed that the heater hoses are old and hard and should be replaced sometime soon, however I didn't want to do this job immediately. The mechanic snapped one off when he put the engine back in to show me how old and hard they actually are (Boo!) so now I need to remove the heater to replace the hoses which go into the top of the heater box. I might just bypass the heater for the short term.

The gearbox was internally inspected and found to be in excellent health (Yay!). It is also now resplendent in green paint.

Many months ago when this job began I advised the mechanic that the headers that I had been offered by Ian Richter would possibly not fit with the twin SU manifold. He was confident that they would fit my car so spent hours welding them into place last Friday only to find when he went to install the manifold that it would not fit (Boo!). A different set of headers will be ordered and hopefully arrive swiftly so that

the delay won't be too long. He suggested another alternative could be spending even more money to buy a new inlet manifold and a third SU carburettor, but I think headers that are designed for my car would be a wiser and cheaper choice. The newly painted headers will go back to Ian's shed - I'm sure he would consider sensible offers if you are keen!

I was hoping to have my BN7 ready for the resumption of our Austin-Healey Owners Club workshops at Col and Kerrie Rule's place in two weeks but that's not likely to happen now!



From Raymond (I'm Still Bored) Roberts

Windscreen Wiper Motor Mounting

I have only come across this problem twice. Once with myself and the other was a MGA owner who was on tour, but had to cut it short and head for home because he was caught in rain.

The symptom is the wiper arms do not do a full sweep and it just gets worse, making it harder and harder to see and to drive safely adding stress to the crew.

Also from Raymond (I'm Still Bored) Roberts

OASIS NEWS 27-10-2021

Hello Oasis Members, I hope you are all well and have got through lockdowns, vaccinations, restrictions, flat batteries and tyres, overgrown hair etc.

Unfortunately I have not been able to book a venue suitable for our November Remembrance Day Run to suit members, venue, restrictions and current booking rules in place.

“THE GOOD NEWS” OUR CHRISTMAS LUNCHEON WILL GO AHEAD
WHEN: Tuesday 7th December 2021

What has happened: The wiper motor rubber mountings have slowly disintegrated allowing the wiper motor to move instead of the wiper arms wiping.

In case you didn't know the wiper motor is not bolted metal to metal in your car, but is mounted through three rubber grommets. Regular inspection of the mounts should be carried out, which is of course a good way to play with your car. Replacement mounts are available from all the usual places including The Healey Factory.

MEET: Tench Reserve, Tench Avenue, Jamisontown (Penrith)

TIME: From 10.30am onwards for BYO morning tea. Some seating available, but bring a chair

DEPART: 12.00 noon

LUNCH: 12.30 – 15.00pm Booking

WHERE: O'Donoghue's Irish Pub 99 Great Western Hwy. Cnr. Station St. Emu Plains
Wear your best Christmas shirt and hat. Bring along some small table decorations to add some colour and atmosphere to our luncheon. To help with catering & seating I would like names & numbers by Tuesday 30-11-2021

DETAILS: Les Watton ph: 9838 8063 m: 0418 973 866 Email: mumspalace@hotmail.com



An interesting photo. It shows the Jensen Motors factory at West Bromwich, England in the late 1950s and if you look closely you will see Austin-Healeys on trailers near the bottom left hand corner and Jensen 541s on the middle of the right. If you will remember it was Jensen that assembled the Big Healey less mechanicals before they were shipped to BMC initially at Longbridge followed by Abingdon.

For Sale

and

Wanted



FOR SALE

Aluminium fuel tank. 105 litres to suit Austin-Healey 100, 100/6 or 3000. Could be used for other applications. Fitted with Austin-Healey sender unit. Tank dimensions: Width 760cm x Depth 425cm and height 325cm.

Excellent condition. \$150.00

Set of four wheels to suit Austin-Healey 15" x 8" 4.5" offset. With mag centre and steel rims, excellent conditions. \$600.00.

Please contact Peter Ford on 0412 084 062 or peter.charles.ford@gmail.com

WANTED TO PURCHASE

Austin-Healey Sprite Mk1.
Ex Member Keith Manwaring is on the look-out for a Bugeye Sprite. Happy to pay well for the right car.

Keith may be contacted on 0422 892 479

Six-cylinder LHD steering box and sideshift gearbox in any condition.

Please contact 0417 673 065



Another interesting photo. This was taken in London in 1964 and as you can see it shows what is either a BJ7 or BJ8 in what would have been new condition.

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Alan Mitchell has kindly sent in a photo of his collection of Austin-Healey plastic model kits and asks how many of us made them when we were younger.

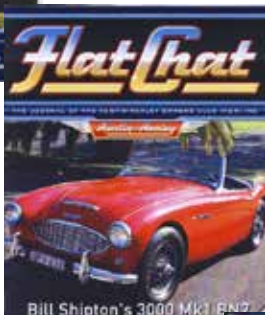
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Patrick Quinn
"Wongaburra"
116 Warks Hill Road
Kurrajong Heights
NSW 2758

You can give me the drive (& stamp) at a meeting.



1973 Calder Six-Hour Relay Race

by Patrick Quinn

A few days back I went looking for a photo and was reminded of Chris Dimmock's website on his black and white BJ8. If you haven't had a looksee at the site you can find it at <https://www.myaustinhealey.com/>

As you look through the site you will find a section of the 1973 Six-Hour Relay Race at Calder Raceway, north-west of Melbourne. Within is an article I wrote for Chris in 2000 on the event that I thought might still be of interest.

Many more years have passed and while I haven't made too many changes to the original article there are a few additions that have been placed within { }. Unfortunately there are not an abundance of photos of the event as they have been lost in the mists of time.

Patrick Quinn Esq's memories of the first NSW assault on a 6 hour relay race - Calder, Victoria 1973.

Patrick Quinn Esq. wrote this article for me about the 1973 6 hour relay race at Calder, Victoria. Patrick was part of the first AHOC 6 hour relay race team, along with Wally Gates (in the 'black & white car').

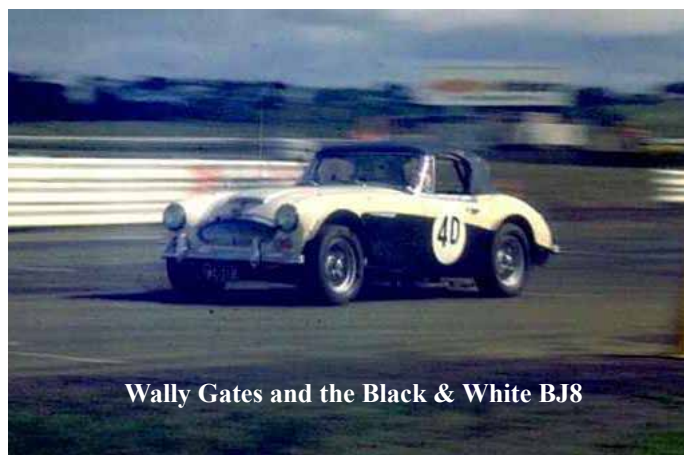
Dear Chris

To start with I would like to congratulate you on your website. It truly is wonderful and I believe that you have done proud by the Black and White car. Please keep it up and I look forward to seeing it expand to include new information about the car and perhaps even the early competition history and restoration of your BN1. {At the time Chris Dimmock also had a BN1 - BN1/152199}

I note with some pleasure that you have included information about the various six-hour relay races that Wally Gates competed in, particularly the 1973 event. Perhaps you may allow me to contribute in my own small way to your site.

I see the names of the competitors in the 1973 event and with some sadness I note that I am the only one still involved with Austin-Healeys. Tragically Alan

Jones (3000 MkI BT7) – {HBT7L/10754} died as a result of a car accident in 1979 while attending the Winton Historic races. Peter Hopwood (3000 MkIII BJ8) - {HBJ8/35950} succumbed to cancer a year or two back. {Now over 20 years} I last saw Chris Gray (100 BN1 fitted with 100S front shroud and grille) – {BN1/224691} at a concours a few years ago {add 20 years} and I don't know what he is up to now. Wally Gates (3000 MkIII BJ8) – {HBJ8/37244} as you know retired from the teaching profession and is now sunning himself in Queensland. {Actually Northern NSW}. Somehow I can't imagine Wally retired from anything and I suspect that he is busy on some project or another. He was the first fellow Austin-Healey owner I had met after I bought my BN1 in 1972 and he enthused me right from the start.



Wally Gates and the Black & White BJ8

It's also hard to imagine that the 1973 six-hour relay race was twenty-eight years ago {now 48 years} - just where has all that time gone? The Austin-Healey Owners Club was certainly a different club then to what it is now. Membership used to float around the 120 to 140 mark every year with the occasional car coming in from overseas. Non-running 100s could be had for around the \$400 mark and if you sold it for \$450 you were very happy with the result. You would have to pay around the \$1,000 to \$1,200 for a registered 100 in good condition. I paid top dollar to John Thompson Sports Cars for my BN1 at \$1,295 in April 1972. {BN1/150616 and now in the UK} There was another one for \$1,100 that was bought by Jim Gray (Chris Gray's father), the last time I saw that car was during the late 1980s when it was in pieces at the Gray's home in Turrumurra. There was also a red BJ8 {HBJ8/29376 ex Colin Rule} going for \$3,000 which was way out of my league - it was bought by Mal French which made me think that

Calder cont'

Qantas stewards were overpaid. It's funny thinking about it now that the BJ8 would have only been six to eight years old at the time and if my memory is right Mal eventually sold it to Western Australia. {Where it still is.}

Yes the cars were certainly far more affordable then in comparison to now which I have often thought is somewhat unfortunate. Sure we have all gained financially, but so what as you have to sell what you have to capitalise. I wonder how many true enthusiasts are out there who would love to buy an Austin-Healey, but it's out of their reach?

Anyway enough of that, and move on to the 1973 Calder Six-Hour Relay Race. As I said it was a very different AHOC back then. If the Club ended up in the black at the end of the financial year it was a successful year. However the whole club was very competition minded and looking back at a few records, the club had twenty-six starters at one Oran Park lap dash and thirty-three to an Amaroo Park hillclimb. It's no wonder we won the CSCA Championship by a mile. Yes I think the reason behind this was the cost of the cars and plus we were somewhat younger.

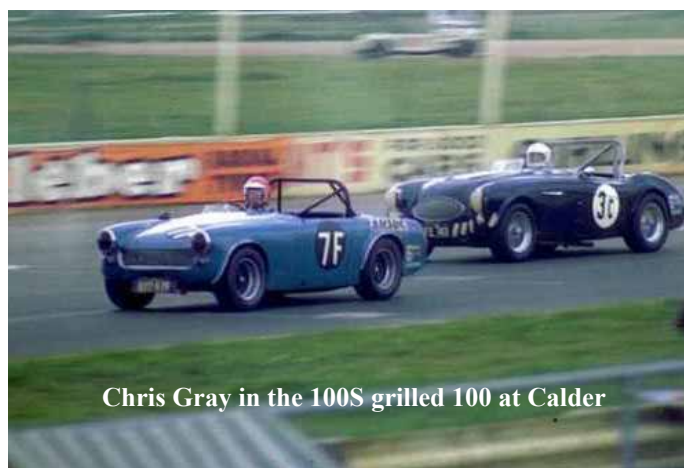
I can recall Alan Jones mentioning the relay race during a club meeting in early 1973 and suggesting that the AHOC form a team. There was great enthusiasm from all involved and within just a couple of weeks Peter Hopwood and I were attending various CAMS lectures with the aim of achieving our competition licences. That was soon followed by our observed practice at Oran Park where we sailed through without difficulties. It should be said that obtaining a CAMS licence back then was a little easier than it is today.

A little time before that I had managed to blow the engine in a big way and for some time ran around with an Austin A70 Hereford unit under the bonnet courtesy of {ex-member} John Watson's father. There were none of the recognised repairers around back in the early 1970s and definitely no such thing as steel cranks and the like. Armed with a couple of cylinder heads of dubious quality and two cranks mostly courtesy of Wally Gates I headed towards Ken Waggott Speed Equipment who had agreed to rebuild the engine. Actually the trip was a story in itself as we removed the passenger seat from Doug Treloar's 3000 BT7 MkII – {HBT7/17738} and

loaded the whole lot onto the floor, block and all. I sat on the passenger side jump seat regally waving to passers-by.

My instructions to Waggotts were straightforward in that I wanted the bore to not go past +40 thou and very finally balanced. They did a great job as it had plenty of power and would rev way past the red line without any detriment. All up the engine rebuild cost just over \$800.00 - yes it was a little cheaper to rebuild an engine back then too.

As I said club enthusiasm was riding high and besides the five drivers there was also a huge group of support people including a Team Manager and Team Mechanic. The president of the club at the time was Ben Sellers who is still involved in historic racing {sadly no longer with us} and also doubled as our Team Mechanic. Ben would bend over backwards to help, especially if you happened to own an Austin-Healey. So keen was Ben that he persuaded the team that it really had to practice for the relay. I can also remember being at Ben's home at Guildford in suburban Sydney up to 3am one Sunday rebuilding the gearbox from Peter Hopwood's BJ8. Anyway we agreed to hold a practice day at Oran Park on the outskirts of Sydney and thinking about it now I wondered what we were supposed to practice.



Chris Gray in the 100S grilled 100 at Calder

So around and around we went having a great time. We stopped on occasions to swap the sash, as during the actual event the drivers had to wear a sash around your neck and under your arm. The AHOC back then even had a club photographer on the committee. He was Warwick Foster who accompanied us to Oran Park and to Calder where he took both still and cine film - way before the days of video. I haven't seen Warwick for years. {Still haven't and have no idea what happened to the film and photos.}

Calder cont'

My main memory of the Oran Park practice was Wally losing the black and white BJ8 in a big way and putting the car backwards into the wall at BP Energol (that's what it was called then). Wally was not a happy camper with his little escapade, but in true Wally style set about to fix the car then and there. How? Well he tied one end of a towrope to the stanchion supporting the main spectator stand and the other end somehow to the rear shroud of the car and kept driving forward pulling the dent out from the car. By the time he had finished it didn't look too bad and when I saw the car the following weekend the car looked its normal immaculate self. That was Wally all over and so full of enthusiasm.

I took some leave from work prior to the event and fitted an aero screen, side exhaust and extractors to the car. I had made arrangements with fellow club member Kevin Gardner {not seen for years} to tow the car to Calder behind his father's Valiant. Peter Hopwood was also towing his car and Alan left a week or so early to stay with his sister north of Melbourne and do all the preparatory work there. Wally in the BJ8? Well he drove the car of course with John Watson as passenger. I can't recall how Chris Gray got to the event.

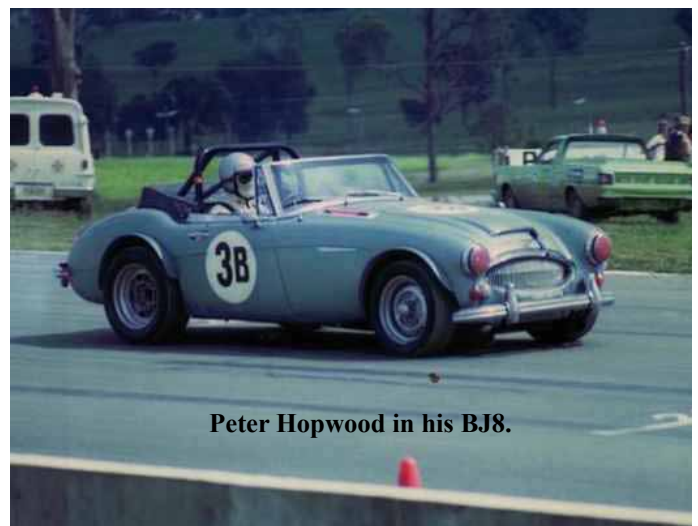
Unfortunately the trip was not without adventure, and remember this was before the Hume Highway was a four lane boring piece of bitumen and meandered around every tree and hill. Back then Kevin and Christine Lyttle were an item so it was three up in the Valiant. The trip was no difficulty until just north of Seymour in Victoria when either the hired trailer swung across the middle of the road or a Toyota Crown did the same. Anyway both tried to occupy the same space at the same time, with the result that I woke up from a sound sleep on the back seat to find the car and trailer both going sideways towards a rather large and unsympathetic gum tree. Luckily there was six inches of water on the side of the road, which slowed our sideways movement significantly.

Five minutes later around the corner comes Wally and John in the BJ8. They stop and with Vegemite sandwiches in hand run across to the scene to see if we were okay. Thankfully everyone was okay except I seem to remember that the Toyota driver was a little peeved about the damage to his almost new car. We told Wally that there wasn't much he could

do and sent him to the next town to raise the alarm. Soon there was a mixture of police and tow trucks all over the place. The Crown had to be towed away while the trailer was completely lifted off the ground and taken into Seymour. The 100 was fine except for a little damage to the rear shroud. The police were very understanding and were quite happy for me to drive the BN1 to Calder. However we only got as far as Seymour where we met up with Peter and Carol Hopwood who were with fellow members Noel and Jo Laughton in their 327 HT Monaro. {Not seen them for years either} Peter suggested that we put my car on his trailer so that he could run his engine in driving the rest of the way. I went with him in his BJ8; Christine in the Monaro and poor Kevin remained in Seymour to sort of the mess.

After all that, we finally managed to make it to Calder and our first practice. Actually this part is rather cloudy, as my grey cells have filed this away into a spot that is almost irretrievable.

What I can recall is that we all circulated in unspectacular style. In fact it was so unspectacular that with the exception of Peter we looked as if we were out on a Sunday drive through the country. Peter was pushing his car hard and no doubt enjoying himself. I should say that there were also teams from both the Victorian and South Australian Austin-Healey clubs.



Peter Hopwood in his BJ8.

We spent the late afternoon with Ben devising our race plan for the following day. Remember it was a six-hour event and we thought that it was just a simple matter of dividing that by five and getting stuck into it. Alan was to go out first, followed by Peter, then Chris, myself and finally Wally. No we didn't even consider that something would go wrong.

Calder cont'

Sunday dawned clear and fresh with the start scheduled for 10am. If I remember that in addition to the drivers some thirty-six of our members had travelled to Melbourne for the event, really an amazing figure considering the size of our club at the time. It was a Le Mans start with Alan running across the straight and into his car where our team manager John Watson would fit him with the sash. After settling down Alan started to circulate very smoothly, but just on 30 minutes into the race his car went off song and the sash was handed to Peter.

I have been involved with Austin-Healeys for close on to 30 years {now 50} and I have met quite a few guys who could make them sing. However if I was to nominate the best it would have to be Ben Sellers and within a few moments he had sorted out Alan's car. Alan had quite correctly fitted a new set of ignition points for the event, but for no known reason the spring had lost its tension and therefore the points wouldn't close properly. Peter Hopwood was left to circulate for his hour plus period, which was greatly curtailed just 20 minutes later when a fan blade parted company from its partners.

Having a fan blade coming adrift is serious enough, but as it made its escape it sliced through the radiator inlet pipe on the top header tank before bouncing off the underneath of the bonnet and slicing back through the header tank and into the radiator itself. Peter managed to get into the pits without serious damage to the engine and Chris Gray was sent on his way.

Luckily for the team there was the BJ8 {HBJ8/40388} of Victorian club member Graeme Rogers in the pits and he graciously allowed Peter and Ben to relieve it of its radiator and fan to install into Peter's car. By coincidence Andy had just a month or two prior purchased the car from long-term NSW club members Larry and Helen Johns.

Chris Gray's turn on the circuit was also beset by gremlins. Not long into his stint Chris' 100 went on to three cylinders and he came into the pits and I was sent out for my turn. Actually I wasn't due to go out on to the circuit for another 90 minutes, but at least the car was fuelled and ready to go. It didn't take long for Ben to diagnose that the gap had closed up on a spark plug. The cause took a little extra time to

find. Chris had recently had his carburettors rebuilt and one of the little screws holding the butterfly on to the spindle had come adrift, found its way into the combustion chamber, push up by the piston on to the park plug and closed the gap. An amazing set of circumstances.



Wally Gates in the Black & White BJ8 at Calder

I recall motoring around the Calder circuit for some time and really enjoying myself. Not setting scintillating times, but keeping to the lap times set for me, after all the team with the most completed laps would win. Almost an hour in when I heard a very familiar tapping sound from the gearbox. I had broken a tooth on second gear in the laygear. Wally went out in the black and white BJ8.

In typical Wally Gates style he just got stuck into it and circulated with great aplomb for over an hour with the occasional stoush while passing or being passed. Just before he was due to come in he signalled that he was coming in early and Alan was made ready again. It turned out that Wally had noticed smoke coming out from behind the radio and naturally he was the butt of all our jokes as to why he had his radio on during a race.

Honestly Chris my memory of the remainder of the race is very cloudy, but I do know that the maladies continued with Graeme Rogers once again providing parts on a short-term loan for Peter's car. It got to one stage that the only car was in any way going was my BN1 so I put in a further twenty minutes of two-speed racing. Funny thing was that my lap times weren't much slower. I seem to remember that there was about eighty minutes left to run when I came back in and Wally and the black and white BJ8 was the only other car fit to run. So out he went and quickly settled into his quick and normal lap speeds for the remainder of the event. We were later very

Calder cont'

appreciative of Wally's efforts, but that didn't stop us from asking him what station he had been listening to.

It was 4 pm and the checkered flag was waved and Wally came in to a rousing applause and back slapping from his fellow club members. He had done well and apart from the smoke escaping from the Lucas wiring the car performed faultlessly.

A considerable amount of liquid refreshment was consumed during the lull immediately following the event. I remember removing the numbers and our specially produced club logo and name from the car while at the same time removing the paint as well. Thankfully Don Read had recently purchased a new air compressor and was eager to try it out when we got back to Sydney.

Where did we come out of some twenty plus teams? I think we came dead last, but my hazy memory tells me that this was changed a little time later to second last. However that really didn't matter as we all agreed that our club spirit was at an all-time high at that event. There were later relay races both at Calder and here in Sydney and they were great, but didn't quite match the first with the amount of enthusiasm and enjoyment. I'm afraid to say that I haven't seen it since at a competition event.

There is another story here concerning getting back to Sydney. Borrowing a muffler, windscreen and such from Steve Pike, driving behind Kevin and Christine all the way back while they flat towed a hastily repaired trailer. The four-wheel trailer being down to just two wheels, losing a wheel somewhere into the bush and having to buy new wheel nuts for the trailer. The driver's side wheel of the trailer pointing off at an angle and having the tyre blow out at 1 am in the morning. Trying to buy a tyre at 1:15 in the morning and dropping the trailer off at the hire place before dawn hoping they wouldn't notice the mess. Finally rushing home, having a shower, getting dressed and arriving at work trying to look as if I didn't need any sleep. Oh yes the trailer guy phoned me in the morning, I filled in lots of forms and never heard anything more.

I know that it was a long time ago Chris, but I think that the 1973 Calder Six Hour Race would have to be one of the highlights of my almost 30 years {now 50} of Austin-Healey ownership. Needless to say I am pleased to have shared it with fellow club members and their cars, including Wally and the Black and White 3000.

Regards

Patrick Quinn Esq



Thank you to Tony Bond for sending these two photos of his wife Samantha with their BJ8 overlooking Lake George north of Canberra. I understand that the 3000 is in constant use and there is almost a daily discussion over who is going to drive the car to and from work. I didn't ask who has the most enjoyable commute.



What about Lake George in the background? The last time I saw the lake so full was back in the early 1960s when we were doing the unheard of 80 mph along the shore of the lake in my uncle's new Holden EK.

Another One

How do they end up like this?



Free to a Good Home

by Patrick Quinn



I suppose there is always a first for everything as I cannot recall of an Austin-Healey being given away.

However I do remember in the early 1970s when I was given two 100 chassis that I stored behind the coke-bin at my mother's place at Kensington. Don't go looking for them as they were eventually passed on and used for other projects.

Anyway Steve Byers in Havelock, North Carolina has recently advertised a BJ7 that's FREE TO A GOOD HOME, but it must be picked from his home.

If Steve's name is familiar to you, that's because he is the BJ8 registrar.

Steve wrote saying that he found this car parked behind the previous owner's house in Lynchburg, Virginia in 1984. He only wanted the turn signal unit, but the owner would not sell parts because a relative had provided money to hold it for restoration. She eventually sold it to Steve for only slightly more than he would have paid her for the turn signal. The car was intact, except for the glass which was "shot out with a BB gun by a neighbourhood hoodlum."

The BJ7 was parked outside without cover for who knows how long, the top rotted away so the floors are non-existent, and the tops of both frame rails under the cockpit are gone. The engine was, and still is, frozen. Since it's been with Steve it has been parked outside on blocks, but under cover. He removed some parts to store inside and did some early body-work to stabilise the rust and prevent it from getting worse, with the goal of eventually getting it on the road again. Steve used its gearbox and overdrive in his BJ8 for ten years until his BJ8 unit was rebuilt.

Like so many of us, Steve came to the realisation that due to other more important projects and age, he is unlikely to make any progress with it. It's restorable, but requires a new chassis. Steel exterior panels have rust damage, but are repairable, while the rear shroud is perfect and the front has received more than its fair share of bog.

Steve classified himself as a motivated donor, due to his wife Freida indicating that either the car goes or he does.

It's understood that the 3000 has been claimed and has been promised a bright future.

Healey 707 - For Sale

by Patrick Quinn

In case you're wondering what it is, the Healey 707 is a Healey Marine boat. Over the years we have looked closely at the formation of Healey Marine and the various models of Healey boats that were produced.

The first Healey Sportsboats were of clinker timber construction and powered by marineised BMC 1500cc engines, of which we do have one within our club. However by the mid to late 1950s the use of fibreglass became more common including with Healey Marine.

An example was the Healey 707 with a fibreglass hull, but still with copious amounts of wooden panelling plus brass and chrome plated fittings. Named after Boeing's new commercial jet airliner, the Healey 707 had something that was of interest in period and continues to be.

The Healey 707 was powered by a marineised version of the BMC C-series six-cylinder that was fitted to the 3000 Mk2 Roadster complete with triple SU carburettors. Interestingly the Healey 707 was not fitted with the customary propeller and rudder, but came standard with the Dowty Jet Drive. Following the 707, Healey Marine would go on to manufacture fibreglass boats specifically for outboards.

The number of Healey 707s produced is not known and similarly the number remaining is also not known. So it was interesting to see one come up for sale at the end of October in Car and Classic. It is understood that the boat received a very sympathetic restoration in 2007 with special attention being paid to original fittings.

According to the website the Healey 707 sold for €42,000 which is the equivalent of just under Aus\$65,000



How to recalibrate your torque wrench at home

By Daniel Strohl from October 2021 issue of Hemmings Motor News

Many thanks to Hemmings Motor News for the below. If you wish to read further informative articles have a look at <https://www.hemmings.com/newsletter>

To do this you just need a vise, a weight, and some simple math. (Plus a US to Au language translator)

Tag sale (garage sale PQ) season is upon us here in New England, which means good opportunities to score tools for cheap. Most times I browse the rows upon rows of tools upchucked from the dearly departed Uncle Buck's tool chest onto an old dog blanket simply looking for items I don't already have, but I always keep my eye out for those screaming, can't-pass deals.



The relatively clean torque wrench I recently came across looked like one of those deals. There was no brand name etched into it, and it didn't come with a case, but for less than the price of a beer, I figured I wouldn't go broke even if it were a dud. But how do I find out if it is worth using before I trust it with torquing down, say, the axle nut on the Chenoweth's transaxle? Especially if I don't care to spend almost as much as a brand-new torque wrench just for a professional calibration? Fortunately, there's a rather simple method for doing so at home using nothing more than a vise, a weight, and some math.



The wrench itself, as noted above, didn't appear abused, other than the fact that it hadn't been kept in its case for some indeterminate amount of time. I also noted that the previous owner of the wrench left it set at ten pounds or so instead of returning it to zero. And without knowing how old it was or how many cycles it had gone through, I had no way of telling whether it was even close to accurate. I did cycle it a few times on a random bolt just to lubricate the mechanism before getting to work.



I first measured from the head of the wrench to the handle, trying to find a good easily-divisible number to mark a length. Had I gone with 12 inches, I'd have covered the numbers for adjusting the wrench with my mark, so I went with 14 inches as you see here. To avoid marking the wrench itself, I just marked a piece of tape wrapped around the wrench. This also helped when I later decided to move the mark to 15 inches in order to make the math a little simpler.



Torque Wrench cont'

Next, I went in search of a known weight that I could tie a string around. Quickest thing I could come up with was a milk jug I plucked from the recycling bin, filled with a little less than a gallon of water. No, that scale's not precise at all, but I did buy it at the Hershey swap meet many years ago, and I did calibrate it against another known weight (that I couldn't tie a string around and thus couldn't use). The heavier the better here. Also, the more easily divisible the weight, the better. I would have preferred more than eight pounds, but this is what I had on hand. Around the handle I tied a length of string—not too long, for reasons you'll see in a moment—then I looped the string on the other end.

Here's where the first round of math comes in. To adjust my torque wrench to the right setting, I first need to multiply the length (15 inches) by the weight (eight pounds), then divide by 12 to get ten foot-pounds. That's about as low as I'd want to go for this process, and I would have preferred 20 foot-pounds. But by the time I realized this, the garbage truck had already collected my recycling.



Here's where the vise comes in. First, I set the torque wrench to ten foot-pounds, then I clamped the square drive in the vise so the wrench sat fairly level. I could have also put a socket on the wrench and hung it level from a well-torqued nut, but that would have required a nut high enough to dangle the eight-pound weight. If the wrench were calibrated properly, I would have heard it click when I put the full weight of the milk jug and water on the line I marked earlier. All would have been right with the world, and I would have given the people running that tag sale a thumbs up the next time I saw them around town. Instead, it did not click. Were this a torque wrench

with a calibration screw, I could simply remove the weight, tighten the spring, then hang the weight again until it did click (or, vice versa, if it clicked easily or with less than eight pounds applied to it, I would have to loosen the spring until it just clicked). But I spent hamburger money on this torque wrench, so of course that's not the case.



Adjust the wrench, or adjust your math just because this wrench doesn't have a calibration screw doesn't necessarily mean all is wasted. It's still possible to find the transition point (the point when the wrench clicks) by moving the weight up the wrench (for a wrench that clicks easily) or down the wrench (for one that, like mine, doesn't click), then measuring that transition point and using that as a multiplier when setting the wrench for future use. So, for instance, if the transition point were at 16 inches, I'd divide the original length (15 inches) by that new length to get the multiplier (0.9375). Were a bolt to require 30 foot-pounds of torque, I'd then apply the multiplier to set the wrench at 28.125 foot-pounds.

Unfortunately, I ran out of wrench before I found the transition point, meaning this wrench was so far off calibration it would need a full disassembly and/or a professional restoration and recalibration to ever work properly again.

Should I have bought a torque wrench of indeterminate origins without a calibration screw or a case in the first place? Probably not, lesson learned. But for absolutely zero investment other than a few minutes of my time, I can at least determine for sure the usefulness of the other torque wrenches I'll bring home from future tag sales.